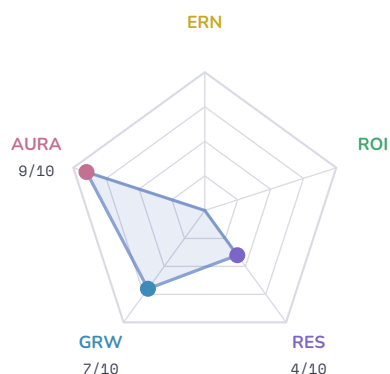


Glad Spry Penguin

Residency: in-state, CA

California Institute of Technology · Mechanical Engineering. · As of May 09, 2026

Mechanical Engineering. at California Institute of Technology: the data shows two or more risk factors worth weighing. Cost-to-earnings is unavailable for this program.



ERN	—	Earnings
ROI	—	Return on Investment
RES	4/10	AI Resilience
GRW	7/10	Growth
AURA	9/10	Brand Gravity

COST & ROI

4-year cost	Modeled debt	Year-1 median earnings*	Debt-to-earnings (yr-1)
\$334,392	\$167,196	\$134,830*	—

Year-1 peer band (this field): \$60,121 – \$69,541 · Program-median Year-1 earnings unavailable for this school.

* Program-median Year-1 earnings unavailable; figure shown is the career-level mid-career wage (national OEWS median) as a reference. Not a graduate's first-year salary.

CAREER RISK PROFILE

Risk Factor	Level	Context
AI displacement risk	ELEVATED	AI exposure sits at the 41th percentile — a meaningful share of tasks could shift to AI within a decade.
Debt burden	Insufficient data	Data unavailable for this program.
Job market outlook	LOW	BLS classifies this as a growing field (growing).
Burnout risk	MODERATE	This occupation has at least one demand worth understanding.
Earnings ceiling	ELEVATED	Year-1 75th-percentile wage is \$69,541 — limited room to grow above the median.

ABOUT THIS CAREER

Design and develop aircraft, spacecraft, and satellites. Use computer software to analyze complex data and solve technical problems. Research information to make informed decisions about flight systems and structures.

Day-to-day

- Use computers to design and model systems
- Analyze technical data and information
- Process complex engineering information
- Solve technical problems and make decisions
- Research and gather new information

SUGGESTED SKILLS

Bring this list to your admissions counselor — these are the skills the data says will lift your outcomes.

QUESTIONS & FOLLOW-UPS

ASK THE COLLEGE

- Which majors at California Institute of Technology most often lead graduates into Aerospace engineers?
- How can I augment this major with the suggested skills above — through coursework, clubs, or internships you already offer?
- Show me how the Mechanical Engineering department integrates machine learning to mitigate AI displacement risks in aerospace design.
- Connect me with alumni who have navigated the elevated earnings ceiling in the aerospace sector.

ASK YOUR PARENTS

- Can our family cover the cost of this program if the debt-to-earnings ratio remains high due to the projected earnings ceiling?
- How much of our savings should we set aside to spare me from high debt service if the aerospace job market remains low?

ASK YOURSELF

- Will I sustain the daily workload of an aerospace engineer if the burnout risk is moderate?
- Do I have the technical aptitude to stay ahead of the automation occurring in mechanical engineering?

GLOSSARY

CIP	Federal program code (Classification of Instructional Programs) — the standard for naming college majors.	RES	AI Resilience — how much of this occupation's work is hard for AI to do, blended from task-level data.
SOC	Federal occupation code (Standard Occupational Classification) — how the BLS names jobs.	GRW	Growth — the BLS 10-year employment-change projection for this occupation.
ERN	Earnings — typical pay for graduates of this program working in this occupation.	AURA	Brand Gravity — institutional pull (selectivity, completion, financial standing) shared by every program at the school.
ROI	Return on Investment — how the cost of this program compares to what graduates earn.	Career risk	Five factors that affect long-term outcomes: AI displacement, debt burden, job market, burnout, and earnings ceiling.